

**Gradient Descent. Convergence for
quadratics; smooth convex case; PL case**

Daniil Merkulov

Optimization for ML. Faculty of Computer Science. HSE University

Gradient Descent

Direction of local steepest descent

Let's consider a linear approximation of the differentiable function f along some direction h , $\|h\|_2 = 1$:

Direction of local steepest descent

Let's consider a linear approximation of the differentiable function f along some direction h , $\|h\|_2 = 1$:

$$f(x + \alpha h) = f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha)$$

Direction of local steepest descent

Let's consider a linear approximation of the differentiable function f along some direction h , $\|h\|_2 = 1$:

$$f(x + \alpha h) = f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha)$$

We want h to be a decreasing direction:

$$f(x + \alpha h) < f(x)$$

$$f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha) < f(x)$$

Direction of local steepest descent

Let's consider a linear approximation of the differentiable function f along some direction h , $\|h\|_2 = 1$:

$$f(x + \alpha h) = f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha)$$

We want h to be a decreasing direction:

$$f(x + \alpha h) < f(x)$$

$$f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha) < f(x)$$

and going to the limit at $\alpha \rightarrow 0$:

$$\langle f'(x), h \rangle \leq 0$$

Direction of local steepest descent

Let's consider a linear approximation of the differentiable function f along some direction h , $\|h\|_2 = 1$:

$$f(x + \alpha h) = f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha)$$

We want h to be a decreasing direction:

$$f(x + \alpha h) < f(x)$$

$$f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha) < f(x)$$

and going to the limit at $\alpha \rightarrow 0$:

$$\langle f'(x), h \rangle \leq 0$$

Also from Cauchy–Bunyakovsky–Schwarz inequality:

$$\begin{aligned} |\langle f'(x), h \rangle| &\leq \|f'(x)\|_2 \|h\|_2 \\ \langle f'(x), h \rangle &\geq -\|f'(x)\|_2 \|h\|_2 = -\|f'(x)\|_2 \end{aligned}$$

Direction of local steepest descent

Let's consider a linear approximation of the differentiable function f along some direction h , $\|h\|_2 = 1$:

$$f(x + \alpha h) = f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha)$$

We want h to be a decreasing direction:

$$f(x + \alpha h) < f(x)$$

$$f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha) < f(x)$$

and going to the limit at $\alpha \rightarrow 0$:

$$\langle f'(x), h \rangle \leq 0$$

Also from Cauchy–Bunyakovsky–Schwarz inequality:

$$\begin{aligned} |\langle f'(x), h \rangle| &\leq \|f'(x)\|_2 \|h\|_2 \\ \langle f'(x), h \rangle &\geq -\|f'(x)\|_2 \|h\|_2 = -\|f'(x)\|_2 \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the direction of the antigradient

$$h = -\frac{f'(x)}{\|f'(x)\|_2}$$

gives the direction of the **steepest local** decreasing of the function f .

Direction of local steepest descent

Let's consider a linear approximation of the differentiable function f along some direction h , $\|h\|_2 = 1$:

$$f(x + \alpha h) = f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha)$$

We want h to be a decreasing direction:

$$f(x + \alpha h) < f(x)$$

$$f(x) + \alpha \langle f'(x), h \rangle + o(\alpha) < f(x)$$

and going to the limit at $\alpha \rightarrow 0$:

$$\langle f'(x), h \rangle \leq 0$$

Also from Cauchy–Bunyakovsky–Schwarz inequality:

$$\begin{aligned} |\langle f'(x), h \rangle| &\leq \|f'(x)\|_2 \|h\|_2 \\ \langle f'(x), h \rangle &\geq -\|f'(x)\|_2 \|h\|_2 = -\|f'(x)\|_2 \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the direction of the antigradient

$$h = -\frac{f'(x)}{\|f'(x)\|_2}$$

gives the direction of the **steepest local** decreasing of the function f .
The result of this method is

$$x_{k+1} = x_k - \alpha f'(x_k)$$

Gradient flow ODE

Let's consider the following ODE, which is referred to as the Gradient Flow equation.

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = -f'(x(t)) \quad (\text{GF})$$

Gradient flow ODE

Let's consider the following ODE, which is referred to as the Gradient Flow equation.

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = -f'(x(t)) \quad (\text{GF})$$

and discretize it on a uniform grid with α step:

$$\frac{x_{k+1} - x_k}{\alpha} = -f'(x_k),$$

Gradient flow ODE

Let's consider the following ODE, which is referred to as the Gradient Flow equation.

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = -f'(x(t)) \quad (\text{GF})$$

and discretize it on a uniform grid with α step:

$$\frac{x_{k+1} - x_k}{\alpha} = -f'(x_k),$$

where $x_k \equiv x(t_k)$ and $\alpha = t_{k+1} - t_k$ - is the grid step.

From here we get the expression for x_{k+1}

$$x_{k+1} = x_k - \alpha f'(x_k),$$

which is exactly gradient descent.

Open In Colab 

Gradient flow ODE

Let's consider the following ODE, which is referred to as the Gradient Flow equation.

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = -f'(x(t))$$

and discretize it on a uniform grid with α step:

$$\frac{x_{k+1} - x_k}{\alpha} = -f'(x_k),$$

where $x_k \equiv x(t_k)$ and $\alpha = t_{k+1} - t_k$ - is the grid step.

From here we get the expression for x_{k+1}

$$x_{k+1} = x_k - \alpha f'(x_k),$$

which is exactly gradient descent.

Open In Colab ♣

(GF)

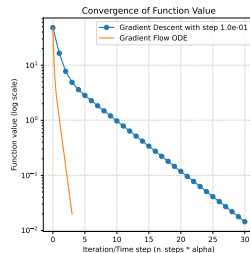
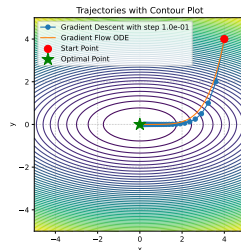
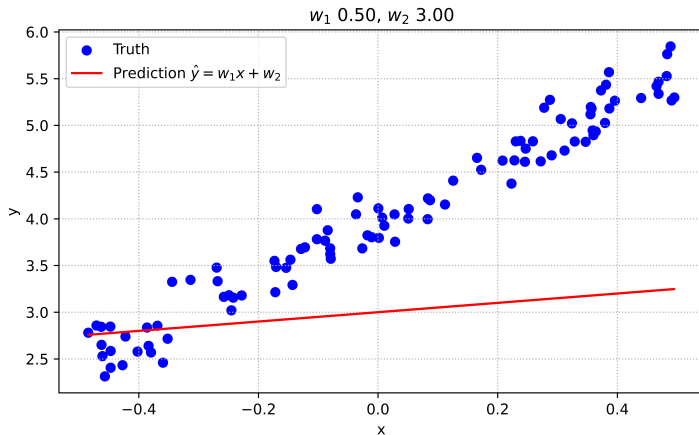
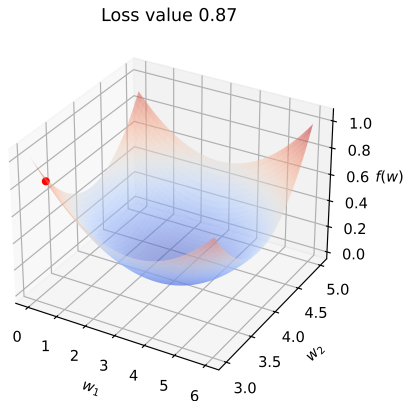


Figure 1: Gradient flow trajectory

Convergence of Gradient Descent algorithm

Heavily depends on the choice of the learning rate α :



Exact line search aka steepest descent

$$\alpha_k = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_{k+1}) = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_k - \alpha \nabla f(x_k))$$

More theoretical than practical approach. It also allows you to analyze the convergence, but often exact line search can be difficult if the function calculation takes too long or costs a lot. An interesting theoretical property of this method is that each following iteration is orthogonal to the previous one:

$$\alpha_k = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_k - \alpha \nabla f(x_k))$$

Exact line search aka steepest descent

$$\alpha_k = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_{k+1}) = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_k - \alpha \nabla f(x_k))$$

More theoretical than practical approach. It also allows you to analyze the convergence, but often exact line search can be difficult if the function calculation takes too long or costs a lot. An interesting theoretical property of this method is that each following iteration is orthogonal to the previous one:

$$\alpha_k = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_k - \alpha \nabla f(x_k))$$

Optimality conditions:

Exact line search aka steepest descent

$$\alpha_k = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_{k+1}) = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_k - \alpha \nabla f(x_k))$$

More theoretical than practical approach. It also allows you to analyze the convergence, but often exact line search can be difficult if the function calculation takes too long or costs a lot. An interesting theoretical property of this method is that each following iteration is orthogonal to the previous one:

$$\alpha_k = \arg \min_{\alpha \in \mathbb{R}^+} f(x_k - \alpha \nabla f(x_k))$$

Optimality conditions:

$$\nabla f(x_{k+1})^\top \nabla f(x_k) = 0$$

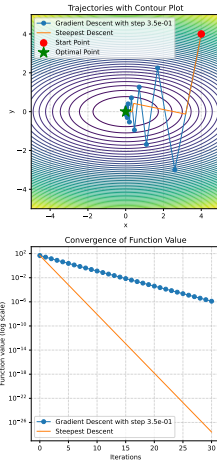


Figure 2: Steepest Descent

Open In Colab

Strongly convex quadratics

Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

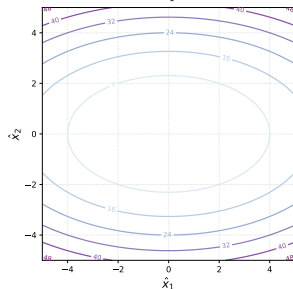
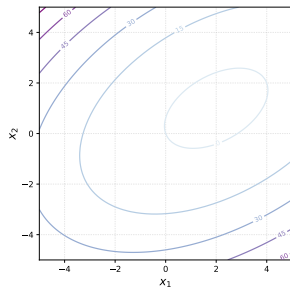
$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

- Firstly, without loss of generality we can set $c = 0$, which will or affect optimization process.

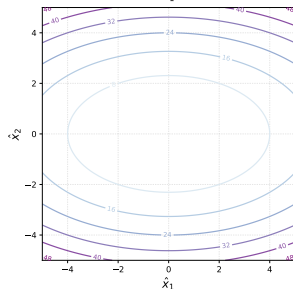
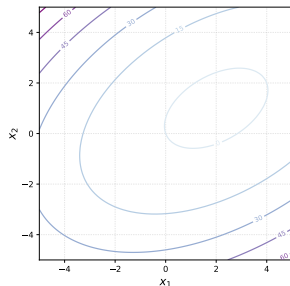


Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

- Firstly, without loss of generality we can set $c = 0$, which will or affect optimization process.
- Secondly, we have a spectral decomposition of the matrix $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$.

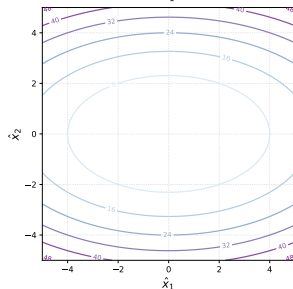
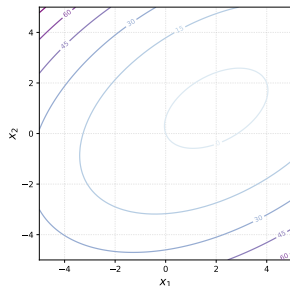


Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

- Firstly, without loss of generality we can set $c = 0$, which will or affect optimization process.
- Secondly, we have a spectral decomposition of the matrix $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$.
- Let's show, that we can switch coordinates to make an analysis a little bit easier. Let $\hat{x} = Q^T(x - x^*)$, where x^* is the minimum point of initial function, defined by $Ax^* = b$. At the same time $x = Q\hat{x} + x^*$.



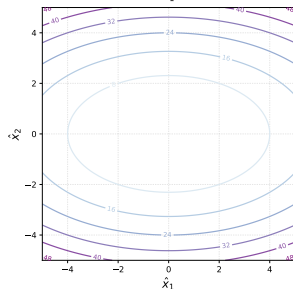
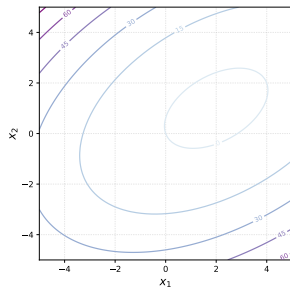
Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

- Firstly, without loss of generality we can set $c = 0$, which will or affect optimization process.
- Secondly, we have a spectral decomposition of the matrix $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$.
- Let's show, that we can switch coordinates to make an analysis a little bit easier. Let $\hat{x} = Q^T(x - x^*)$, where x^* is the minimum point of initial function, defined by $Ax^* = b$. At the same time $x = Q\hat{x} + x^*$.

$$f(\hat{x}) = \frac{1}{2} (Q\hat{x} + x^*)^\top A (Q\hat{x} + x^*) - b^\top (Q\hat{x} + x^*)$$



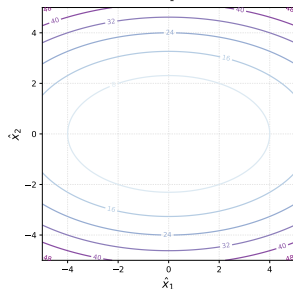
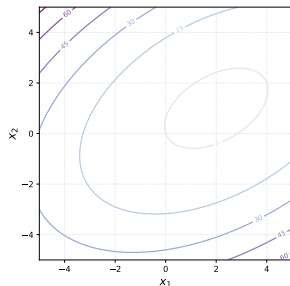
Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

- Firstly, without loss of generality we can set $c = 0$, which will or affect optimization process.
- Secondly, we have a spectral decomposition of the matrix $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$.
- Let's show, that we can switch coordinates to make an analysis a little bit easier. Let $\hat{x} = Q^T(x - x^*)$, where x^* is the minimum point of initial function, defined by $Ax^* = b$. At the same time $x = Q\hat{x} + x^*$.

$$\begin{aligned} f(\hat{x}) &= \frac{1}{2} (Q\hat{x} + x^*)^\top A (Q\hat{x} + x^*) - b^\top (Q\hat{x} + x^*) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top Q^\top A Q \hat{x} + \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A (x^*) + (x^*)^\top A Q \hat{x} - b^\top Q \hat{x} - b^\top x^* \end{aligned}$$



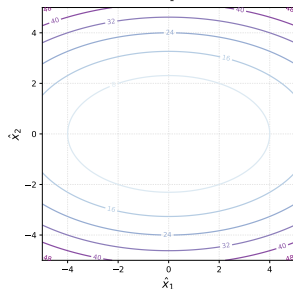
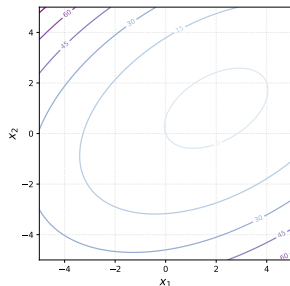
Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

- Firstly, without loss of generality we can set $c = 0$, which will or affect optimization process.
- Secondly, we have a spectral decomposition of the matrix $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$.
- Let's show, that we can switch coordinates to make an analysis a little bit easier. Let $\hat{x} = Q^T(x - x^*)$, where x^* is the minimum point of initial function, defined by $Ax^* = b$. At the same time $x = Q\hat{x} + x^*$.

$$\begin{aligned} f(\hat{x}) &= \frac{1}{2} (Q\hat{x} + x^*)^\top A (Q\hat{x} + x^*) - b^\top (Q\hat{x} + x^*) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top Q^\top A Q \hat{x} + \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A (x^*) + (x^*)^\top A Q \hat{x} - b^\top Q \hat{x} - b^\top x^* \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top \Lambda \hat{x} + \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A (x^*) + (x^*)^\top A Q \hat{x} - (x^*)^\top A^\top Q \hat{x} - (x^*)^\top A x^* \end{aligned}$$



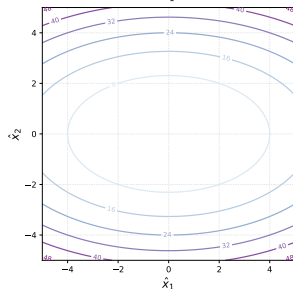
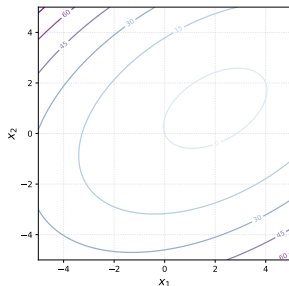
Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

- Firstly, without loss of generality we can set $c = 0$, which will or affect optimization process.
- Secondly, we have a spectral decomposition of the matrix $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$.
- Let's show, that we can switch coordinates to make an analysis a little bit easier. Let $\hat{x} = Q^T(x - x^*)$, where x^* is the minimum point of initial function, defined by $Ax^* = b$. At the same time $x = Q\hat{x} + x^*$.

$$\begin{aligned} f(\hat{x}) &= \frac{1}{2} (Q\hat{x} + x^*)^\top A (Q\hat{x} + x^*) - b^\top (Q\hat{x} + x^*) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top Q^\top A Q \hat{x} + \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A (x^*) + (x^*)^\top A Q \hat{x} - b^\top Q \hat{x} - b^\top x^* \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top \Lambda \hat{x} + \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A (x^*) + (x^*)^\top A Q \hat{x} - (x^*)^\top A^\top Q \hat{x} - (x^*)^\top A x^* \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top \Lambda \hat{x} - \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A x^* \end{aligned}$$



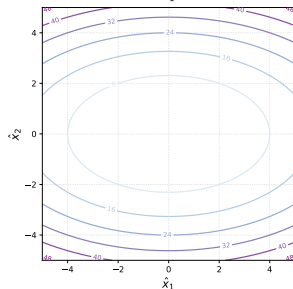
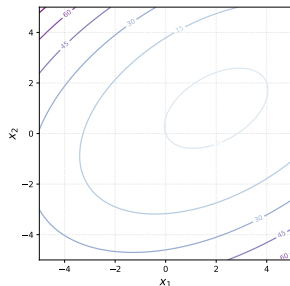
Coordinate shift

Consider the following quadratic optimization problem:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} f(x) = \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d} \frac{1}{2} x^\top A x - b^\top x + c, \text{ where } A \in \mathbb{S}_{++}^d.$$

- Firstly, without loss of generality we can set $c = 0$, which will or affect optimization process.
- Secondly, we have a spectral decomposition of the matrix $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$.
- Let's show, that we can switch coordinates to make an analysis a little bit easier. Let $\hat{x} = Q^T(x - x^*)$, where x^* is the minimum point of initial function, defined by $Ax^* = b$. At the same time $x = Q\hat{x} + x^*$.

$$\begin{aligned} f(\hat{x}) &= \frac{1}{2} (Q\hat{x} + x^*)^\top A (Q\hat{x} + x^*) - b^\top (Q\hat{x} + x^*) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top Q^\top A Q \hat{x} + \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A (x^*) + (x^*)^\top A Q \hat{x} - b^\top Q \hat{x} - b^\top x^* \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top \Lambda \hat{x} + \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A (x^*) + (x^*)^\top A Q \hat{x} - (x^*)^\top A^\top Q \hat{x} - (x^*)^\top A x^* \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top \Lambda \hat{x} - \frac{1}{2} (x^*)^\top A x^* \simeq \frac{1}{2} \hat{x}^\top \Lambda \hat{x} \end{aligned}$$



Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$x^{k+1} = x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k)$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$x^{k+1} = x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$x^{k+1} = x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k$$

$$= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha \mu| < 1$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha \mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha \mu < 1$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha \mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha \mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha \mu > 0$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1 \qquad |1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \qquad \alpha\mu > 0$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha\mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha\mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha\mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \text{ For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha\mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\rho^* = \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha)$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha \mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha \mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha \mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\rho^* = \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha) = \min_{\alpha} \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}|$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha \mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha \mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha \mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\begin{aligned}\rho^* &= \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha) = \min_{\alpha} \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| \\&= \min_{\alpha} \{|1 - \alpha \mu|, |1 - \alpha L|\}\end{aligned}$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha \mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha \mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha \mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha\mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\begin{aligned}\rho^* &= \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha) = \min_{\alpha} \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| \\&= \min_{\alpha} \{|1 - \alpha\mu|, |1 - \alpha L|\}\end{aligned}$$

$$\alpha^* : \quad 1 - \alpha^* \mu = \alpha^* L - 1$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha\mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\begin{aligned}\rho^* &= \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha) = \min_{\alpha} \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| \\&= \min_{\alpha} \{|1 - \alpha\mu|, |1 - \alpha L|\}\end{aligned}$$

$$\alpha^* : 1 - \alpha^* \mu = \alpha^* L - 1$$

$$\alpha^* = \frac{2}{\mu + L}$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha\mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\begin{aligned}\rho^* &= \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha) = \min_{\alpha} \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| \\&= \min_{\alpha} \{|1 - \alpha\mu|, |1 - \alpha L|\}\end{aligned}$$

$$\alpha^* : \quad 1 - \alpha^* \mu = \alpha^* L - 1$$

$$\alpha^* = \frac{2}{\mu + L} \quad \rho^* = \frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu}$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda) x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)}) x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$|1 - \alpha \mu| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha \mu < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha \mu > 0$$

$$|1 - \alpha L| < 1$$

$$-1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1$$

$$\alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\begin{aligned}\rho^* &= \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha) = \min_{\alpha} \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| \\&= \min_{\alpha} \{|1 - \alpha \mu|, |1 - \alpha L|\}\end{aligned}$$

$$\alpha^* : 1 - \alpha^* \mu = \alpha^* L - 1$$

$$\alpha^* = \frac{2}{\mu + L} \quad \rho^* = \frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = \left(\frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu} \right)^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda)x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$\begin{aligned}|1 - \alpha\mu| &< 1 & |1 - \alpha L| &< 1 \\-1 &< 1 - \alpha\mu < 1 & -1 &< 1 - \alpha L < 1 \\ \alpha &< \frac{2}{\mu} & \alpha\mu &> 0 & \alpha &< \frac{2}{L} & \alpha L &> 0\end{aligned}$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\begin{aligned}\rho^* &= \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha) = \min_{\alpha} \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| \\&= \min_{\alpha} \{|1 - \alpha\mu|, |1 - \alpha L|\}\end{aligned}$$

$$\alpha^* : 1 - \alpha^* \mu = \alpha^* L - 1$$

$$\alpha^* = \frac{2}{\mu + L} \quad \rho^* = \frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = \left(\frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu}\right)^k x_{(i)}^0$$

$$\|x^{k+1}\|_2 \leq \left(\frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu}\right)^k \|x^0\|_2$$

Convergence analysis

Now we can work with the function $f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T \Lambda x$ with $x^* = 0$ without loss of generality (drop the hat from the $\hat{x}$)

$$\begin{aligned}x^{k+1} &= x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k) = x^k - \alpha^k \Lambda x^k \\&= (I - \alpha^k \Lambda) x^k\end{aligned}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)}) x_{(i)}^k \quad \text{For } i\text{-th coordinate}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = (1 - \alpha^k \lambda_{(i)})^k x_{(i)}^0$$

Let's use constant stepsize $\alpha^k = \alpha$. Convergence condition:

$$\rho(\alpha) = \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| < 1$$

Remember, that $\lambda_{\min} = \mu > 0$, $\lambda_{\max} = L \geq \mu$.

$$\begin{aligned}|1 - \alpha\mu| < 1 & \qquad |1 - \alpha L| < 1 \\-1 < 1 - \alpha\mu < 1 & \qquad -1 < 1 - \alpha L < 1 \\ \alpha < \frac{2}{\mu} \quad \alpha\mu > 0 & \qquad \alpha < \frac{2}{L} \quad \alpha L > 0\end{aligned}$$

$\alpha < \frac{2}{L}$ is needed for convergence.

Now we would like to tune α to choose the best (lowest) convergence rate

$$\begin{aligned}\rho^* &= \min_{\alpha} \rho(\alpha) = \min_{\alpha} \max_i |1 - \alpha \lambda_{(i)}| \\&= \min_{\alpha} \{|1 - \alpha\mu|, |1 - \alpha L|\}\end{aligned}$$

$$\alpha^* : \quad 1 - \alpha^* \mu = \alpha^* L - 1$$

$$\alpha^* = \frac{2}{\mu + L} \quad \rho^* = \frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu}$$

$$x_{(i)}^{k+1} = \left(\frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu} \right)^k x_{(i)}^0$$

$$\|x^{k+1}\|_2 \leq \left(\frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu} \right)^k \|x^0\|_2 \quad f(x^{k+1}) \leq \left(\frac{L - \mu}{L + \mu} \right)^{2k} f(x^0)$$

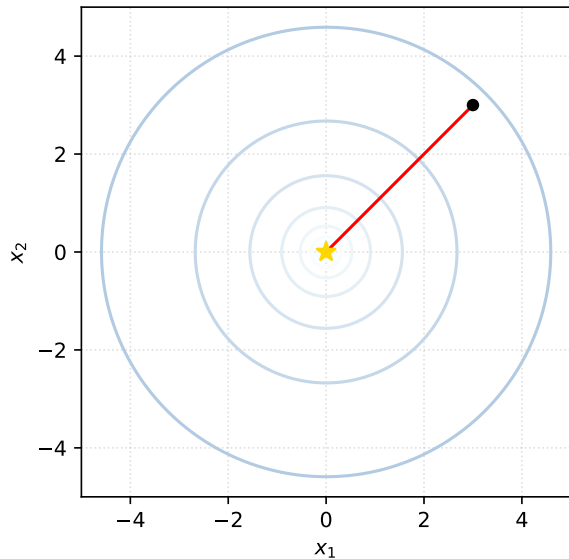
Convergence analysis

So, we have a linear convergence in the domain with rate $\frac{\kappa-1}{\kappa+1} = 1 - \frac{2}{\kappa+1}$, where $\kappa = \frac{L}{\mu}$ is sometimes called *condition number* of the quadratic problem.

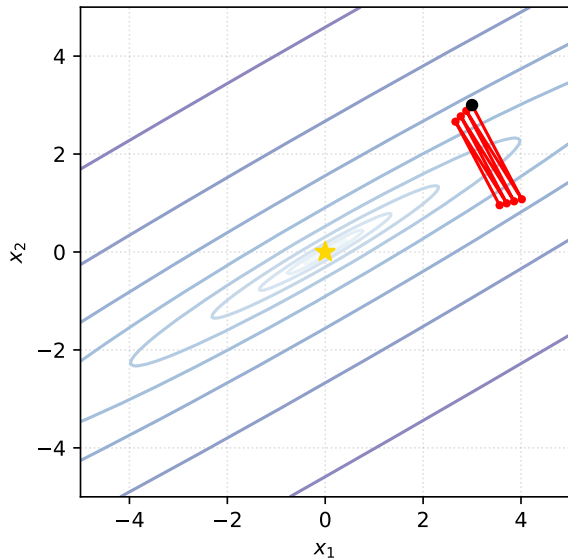
κ	ρ	Iterations to decrease domain gap 10 times	Iterations to decrease function gap 10 times
1.1	0.05	1	1
2	0.33	3	2
5	0.67	6	3
10	0.82	12	6
50	0.96	58	29
100	0.98	116	58
500	0.996	576	288
1000	0.998	1152	576

Condition number κ

$\kappa = 1.0$



$\kappa = 100.0$



Polyak-Lojasiewicz smooth case

Polyak-Lojasiewicz condition. Linear convergence of gradient descent without convexity

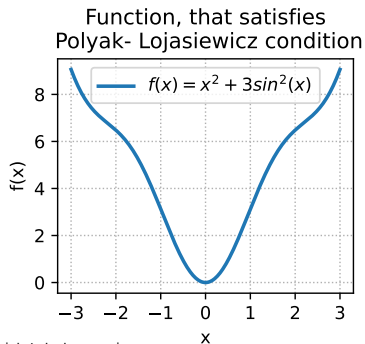
PL inequality holds if the following condition is satisfied for some $\mu > 0$,

$$\|\nabla f(x)\|^2 \geq 2\mu(f(x) - f^*) \quad \forall x$$

It is interesting, that the Gradient Descent algorithm might converge linearly even without convexity.

The following functions satisfy the PL condition but are not convex. [🔗Link to the code](#)

$$f(x) = x^2 + 3\sin^2(x)$$



Polyak-Lojasiewicz condition. Linear convergence of gradient descent without convexity

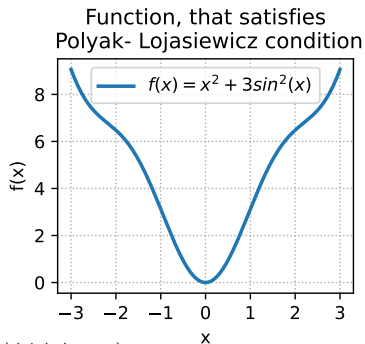
PL inequality holds if the following condition is satisfied for some $\mu > 0$,

$$\|\nabla f(x)\|^2 \geq 2\mu(f(x) - f^*) \quad \forall x$$

It is interesting, that the Gradient Descent algorithm might converge linearly even without convexity.

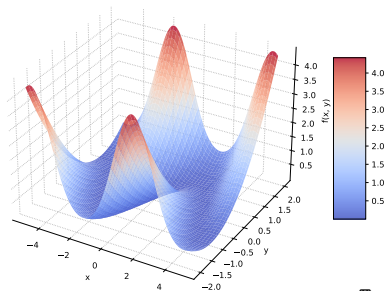
The following functions satisfy the PL condition but are not convex. [🔗Link to the code](#)

$$f(x) = x^2 + 3\sin^2(x)$$



$$f(x, y) = \frac{(y - \sin x)^2}{2}$$

Non-convex PL function



Convergence analysis

i Theorem

Consider the Problem

$$f(x) \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d}$$

and assume that f is μ -Polyak-Lojasiewicz and L -smooth, for some $L \geq \mu > 0$.

Consider $(x^k)_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ a sequence generated by the gradient descent constant stepsize algorithm, with a stepsize satisfying $0 < \alpha \leq \frac{1}{L}$. Then:

$$f(x^k) - f^* \leq (1 - \alpha\mu)^k (f(x^0) - f^*).$$

Convergence analysis

We can use L -smoothness, together with the update rule of the algorithm, to write

$$f(x^{k+1}) \leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2$$

Convergence analysis

We can use L -smoothness, together with the update rule of the algorithm, to write

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

We can use L -smoothness, together with the update rule of the algorithm, to write

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

We can use L -smoothness, together with the update rule of the algorithm, to write

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2, \end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

We can use L -smoothness, together with the update rule of the algorithm, to write

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2, \end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

We can use L -smoothness, together with the update rule of the algorithm, to write

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2, \end{aligned}$$

where in the last inequality we used our hypothesis on the stepsize that $\alpha L \leq 1$.

Convergence analysis

We can use L -smoothness, together with the update rule of the algorithm, to write

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2,\end{aligned}$$

where in the last inequality we used our hypothesis on the stepsize that $\alpha L \leq 1$.

We can now use the Polyak-Lojasiewicz property to write:

$$f(x^{k+1}) \leq f(x^k) - \alpha\mu(f(x^k) - f^*).$$

The conclusion follows after subtracting f^* on both sides of this inequality and using recursion.

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

Theorem

If a function $f(x)$ is differentiable and μ -strongly convex, then it is a PL function.

Proof

By first order strong convexity criterion:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(y - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|y - x\|_2^2$$

Putting $y = x^*$:

$$f(x^*) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(x^* - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

Theorem

If a function $f(x)$ is differentiable and μ -strongly convex, then it is a PL function.

Proof

By first order strong convexity criterion:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(y - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|y - x\|_2^2$$

Putting $y = x^*$:

$$f(x^*) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(x^* - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2$$

$$f(x) - f(x^*) \leq \nabla f(x)^T(x - x^*) - \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2 =$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

Theorem

If a function $f(x)$ is differentiable and μ -strongly convex, then it is a PL function.

Proof

By first order strong convexity criterion:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(y - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|y - x\|_2^2$$

Putting $y = x^*$:

$$f(x^*) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(x^* - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) - f(x^*) &\leq \nabla f(x)^T(x - x^*) - \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2 = \\ &= \left(\nabla f(x)^T - \frac{\mu}{2}(x^* - x) \right)^T (x - x^*) = \end{aligned}$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

i Theorem

If a function $f(x)$ is differentiable and μ -strongly convex, then it is a PL function.

Proof

By first order strong convexity criterion:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(y - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|y - x\|_2^2$$

Putting $y = x^*$:

$$f(x^*) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(x^* - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) - f(x^*) &\leq \nabla f(x)^T(x - x^*) - \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2 = \\ &= \left(\nabla f(x)^T - \frac{\mu}{2}(x^* - x) \right)^T (x - x^*) = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x)^T - \sqrt{\mu}(x^* - x) \right)^T \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) = \end{aligned}$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

Theorem

If a function $f(x)$ is differentiable and μ -strongly convex, then it is a PL function.

Proof

By first order strong convexity criterion:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(y - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|y - x\|_2^2$$

Putting $y = x^*$:

$$f(x^*) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(x^* - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) - f(x^*) &\leq \nabla f(x)^T(x - x^*) - \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2 = \\ &= \left(\nabla f(x)^T - \frac{\mu}{2}(x^* - x) \right)^T (x - x^*) = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x)^T - \sqrt{\mu}(x^* - x) \right)^T \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) = \end{aligned}$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

i Theorem

If a function $f(x)$ is differentiable and μ -strongly convex, then it is a PL function.

Proof

By first order strong convexity criterion:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(y - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|y - x\|_2^2$$

Putting $y = x^*$:

$$f(x^*) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(x^* - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) - f(x^*) &\leq \nabla f(x)^T(x - x^*) - \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2 = \\ &= \left(\nabla f(x)^T - \frac{\mu}{2}(x^* - x) \right)^T (x - x^*) = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x)^T - \sqrt{\mu}(x^* - x) \right)^T \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) = \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{Let } a &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x) \text{ and} \\ b &= \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x) \end{aligned}$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

i Theorem

If a function $f(x)$ is differentiable and μ -strongly convex, then it is a PL function.

Proof

By first order strong convexity criterion:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(y - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|y - x\|_2^2$$

Putting $y = x^*$:

$$f(x^*) \geq f(x) + \nabla f(x)^T(x^* - x) + \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2$$

$$\begin{aligned} f(x) - f(x^*) &\leq \nabla f(x)^T(x - x^*) - \frac{\mu}{2}\|x^* - x\|_2^2 = \\ &= \left(\nabla f(x)^T - \frac{\mu}{2}(x^* - x) \right)^T (x - x^*) = \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{2}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x)^T - \sqrt{\mu}(x^* - x) \right)^T \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) = \end{aligned}$$

Let $a = \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x)$ and

$$b = \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x)$$

Then $a + b = \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*)$ and

$$a - b = \frac{2}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x) - \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*)$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

$$f(x) - f(x^*) \leq \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{1}{\mu} \|\nabla f(x)\|_2^2 - \left\| \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x) \right\|_2^2 \right)$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

$$f(x) - f(x^*) \leq \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{1}{\mu} \|\nabla f(x)\|_2^2 - \left\| \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x) \right\|_2^2 \right)$$
$$f(x) - f(x^*) \leq \frac{1}{2\mu} \|\nabla f(x)\|_2^2,$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

$$f(x) - f(x^*) \leq \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{1}{\mu} \|\nabla f(x)\|_2^2 - \left\| \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x) \right\|_2^2 \right)$$
$$f(x) - f(x^*) \leq \frac{1}{2\mu} \|\nabla f(x)\|_2^2,$$

Any μ -strongly convex differentiable function is a PL-function

$$f(x) - f(x^*) \leq \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{1}{\mu} \|\nabla f(x)\|_2^2 - \left\| \sqrt{\mu}(x - x^*) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{\mu}} \nabla f(x) \right\|_2^2 \right)$$
$$f(x) - f(x^*) \leq \frac{1}{2\mu} \|\nabla f(x)\|_2^2,$$

which is exactly the PL condition. It means, that we already have linear convergence proof for any strongly convex function.

Smooth convex case

Smooth convex case

Theorem

Consider the Problem

$$f(x) \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^d}$$

and assume that f is convex and L -smooth, for some $L > 0$.

Let $(x^k)_{k \in \mathbb{N}}$ be the sequence of iterates generated by the gradient descent constant stepsize algorithm, with a stepsize satisfying $0 < \alpha \leq \frac{1}{L}$. Then, for all $x^* \in \operatorname{argmin} f$, for all $k \in \mathbb{N}$ we have that

$$f(x^k) - f^* \leq \frac{\|x^0 - x^*\|^2}{2\alpha k}.$$

Convergence analysis

- As it was before, we first use smoothness:

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2, \\f(x^k) - f(x^{k+1}) &\geq \frac{1}{2L} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \text{ if } \alpha = \frac{1}{L}\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

Typically, for the convergent gradient descent algorithm the higher the learning rate the faster the convergence. That is why we often will use $\alpha = \frac{1}{L}$.

Convergence analysis

- As it was before, we first use smoothness:

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2, \\f(x^k) - f(x^{k+1}) &\geq \frac{1}{2L} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \text{ if } \alpha = \frac{1}{L}\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

Typically, for the convergent gradient descent algorithm the higher the learning rate the faster the convergence.

That is why we often will use $\alpha = \frac{1}{L}$.

- After that we add convexity:

(2)

Convergence analysis

- As it was before, we first use smoothness:

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2, \\f(x^k) - f(x^{k+1}) &\geq \frac{1}{2L} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \text{ if } \alpha = \frac{1}{L}\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

Typically, for the convergent gradient descent algorithm the higher the learning rate the faster the convergence.

That is why we often will use $\alpha = \frac{1}{L}$.

- After that we add convexity:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \langle \nabla f(x), y - x \rangle\tag{2}$$

Convergence analysis

- As it was before, we first use smoothness:

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2, \\f(x^k) - f(x^{k+1}) &\geq \frac{1}{2L} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \text{ if } \alpha = \frac{1}{L}\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

Typically, for the convergent gradient descent algorithm the higher the learning rate the faster the convergence.

That is why we often will use $\alpha = \frac{1}{L}$.

- After that we add convexity:

$$f(y) \geq f(x) + \langle \nabla f(x), y - x \rangle \text{ with } y = x^*, x = x^k\tag{2}$$

Convergence analysis

- As it was before, we first use smoothness:

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^{k+1} - x^k \rangle + \frac{L}{2} \|x^{k+1} - x^k\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \alpha \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 + \frac{L\alpha^2}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} (2 - L\alpha) \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2, \\f(x^k) - f(x^{k+1}) &\geq \frac{1}{2L} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \text{ if } \alpha = \frac{1}{L}\end{aligned}\tag{1}$$

Typically, for the convergent gradient descent algorithm the higher the learning rate the faster the convergence.

That is why we often will use $\alpha = \frac{1}{L}$.

- After that we add convexity:

$$\begin{aligned}f(y) &\geq f(x) + \langle \nabla f(x), y - x \rangle \text{ with } y = x^*, x = x^k \\f(x^k) - f^* &\leq \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle\end{aligned}\tag{2}$$

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$f(x^{k+1}) \leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2$$

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\ &= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle \end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\ &= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle \end{aligned}$$

Let $a = x^k - x^*$ and $b = x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$.

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\&= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle\end{aligned}$$

Let $a = x^k - x^*$ and $b = x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$. Then $a + b = \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$ and $a - b = 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right)$.

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\ &= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle \end{aligned}$$

Let $a = x^k - x^*$ and $b = x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$. Then $a + b = \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$ and $a - b = 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right)$.

$$f(x^{k+1}) \leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)\|_2^2]$$

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\&= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle\end{aligned}$$

Let $a = x^k - x^*$ and $b = x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$. Then $a + b = \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$ and $a - b = 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right)$.

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)\|_2^2] \\&\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2]\end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\&= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\&= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle\end{aligned}$$

Let $a = x^k - x^*$ and $b = x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$. Then $a + b = \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$ and $a - b = 2(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k))$.

$$\begin{aligned}f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)\|_2^2] \\&\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2] \\2\alpha (f(x^{k+1}) - f^*) &\leq \|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2\end{aligned}$$

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\ &= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle \end{aligned}$$

Let $a = x^k - x^*$ and $b = x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$. Then $a + b = \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$ and $a - b = 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right)$.

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)\|_2^2] \\ &\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2] \\ 2\alpha (f(x^{k+1}) - f^*) &\leq \|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2 \end{aligned}$$

- Now suppose, that the last line is defined for some index i and we sum over $i \in [0, k-1]$. Almost all summands will vanish due to the telescopic nature of the sum:

(3)

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\ &= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle \end{aligned}$$

Let $a = x^k - x^*$ and $b = x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$. Then $a + b = \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$ and $a - b = 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right)$.

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)\|_2^2] \\ &\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2] \\ 2\alpha (f(x^{k+1}) - f^*) &\leq \|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2 \end{aligned}$$

- Now suppose, that the last line is defined for some index i and we sum over $i \in [0, k-1]$. Almost all summands will vanish due to the telescopic nature of the sum:

$$2\alpha \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} (f(x^{i+1}) - f^*) \leq \|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 \quad (3)$$

Convergence analysis

- Now we put Equation 2 to Equation 1:

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f(x^k) - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \leq f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* \rangle - \frac{\alpha}{2} \|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \\ &= f^* + \langle \nabla f(x^k), x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \rangle \\ &= f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} \left\langle \alpha \nabla f(x^k), 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right) \right\rangle \end{aligned}$$

Let $a = x^k - x^*$ and $b = x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$. Then $a + b = \alpha \nabla f(x^k)$ and $a - b = 2 \left(x^k - x^* - \frac{\alpha}{2} \nabla f(x^k) \right)$.

$$\begin{aligned} f(x^{k+1}) &\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^k - x^* - \alpha \nabla f(x^k)\|_2^2] \\ &\leq f^* + \frac{1}{2\alpha} [\|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2] \\ 2\alpha (f(x^{k+1}) - f^*) &\leq \|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^{k+1} - x^*\|_2^2 \end{aligned}$$

- Now suppose, that the last line is defined for some index i and we sum over $i \in [0, k-1]$. Almost all summands will vanish due to the telescopic nature of the sum:

$$2\alpha \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} (f(x^{i+1}) - f^*) \leq \|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2 - \|x^k - x^*\|_2^2 \leq \|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2 \quad (3)$$

Convergence analysis

- Due to the monotonic decrease at each iteration $f(x^{i+1}) < f(x^i)$:

$$kf(x^k) \leq \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} f(x^{i+1})$$

Convergence analysis

- Due to the monotonic decrease at each iteration $f(x^{i+1}) < f(x^i)$:

$$kf(x^k) \leq \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} f(x^{i+1})$$

- Now putting it to Equation 3:

Convergence analysis

- Due to the monotonic decrease at each iteration $f(x^{i+1}) < f(x^i)$:

$$kf(x^k) \leq \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} f(x^{i+1})$$

- Now putting it to Equation 3:

$$2\alpha kf(x^k) - 2\alpha kf^* \leq 2\alpha \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} (f(x^{i+1}) - f^*) \leq \|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2$$

Convergence analysis

- Due to the monotonic decrease at each iteration $f(x^{i+1}) < f(x^i)$:

$$kf(x^k) \leq \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} f(x^{i+1})$$

- Now putting it to Equation 3:

$$2\alpha k f(x^k) - 2\alpha k f^* \leq 2\alpha \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} (f(x^{i+1}) - f^*) \leq \|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2$$
$$f(x^k) - f^* \leq \frac{\|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2}{2\alpha k}$$

Convergence analysis

- Due to the monotonic decrease at each iteration $f(x^{i+1}) < f(x^i)$:

$$kf(x^k) \leq \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} f(x^{i+1})$$

- Now putting it to Equation 3:

$$2\alpha k f(x^k) - 2\alpha k f^* \leq 2\alpha \sum_{i=0}^{k-1} (f(x^{i+1}) - f^*) \leq \|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2$$
$$f(x^k) - f^* \leq \frac{\|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2}{2\alpha k} \leq \frac{L\|x^0 - x^*\|_2^2}{2k}$$

Summary

Gradient Descent:

$$\min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n} f(x)$$

$$x^{k+1} = x^k - \alpha^k \nabla f(x^k)$$

smooth (non-convex)

$$\|\nabla f(x^k)\|^2 \sim \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{1}{k}\right)$$

$$k_\varepsilon \sim \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{1}{\varepsilon}\right)$$

smooth & convex

$$f(x^k) - f^* \sim \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{1}{k}\right)$$

$$k_\varepsilon \sim \mathcal{O}\left(\frac{1}{\varepsilon}\right)$$

smooth & strongly convex (or PL)

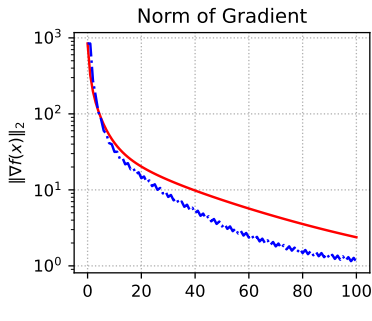
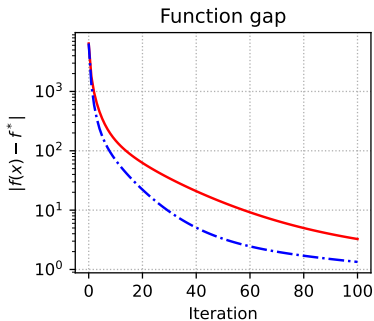
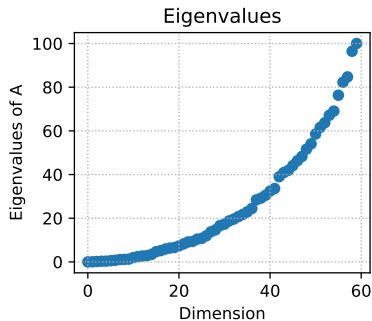
$$\|x^k - x^*\|^2 \sim \mathcal{O}\left(\left(1 - \frac{\mu}{L}\right)^k\right)$$

$$k_\varepsilon \sim \mathcal{O}\left(n \log \frac{1}{\varepsilon}\right)$$

Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T A x - b^T x \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

Convex quadratics. $n=60$, random matrix.



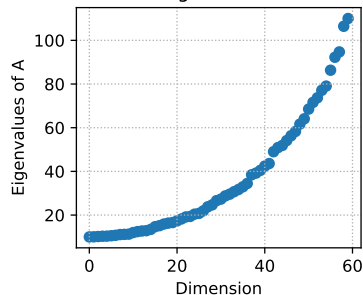
— Gradient Descent -.- Steepest Descent

Numerical experiments

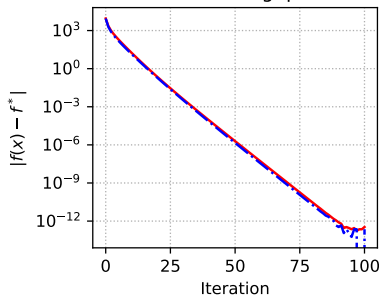
$$f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T A x - b^T x \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

Strongly convex quadratics. $n=60$, random matrix.

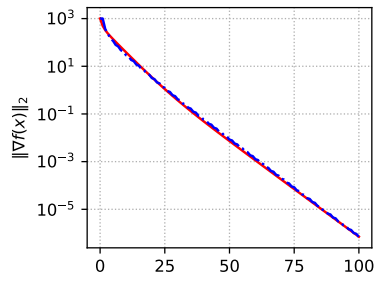
Eigenvalues



Function gap



Norm of Gradient

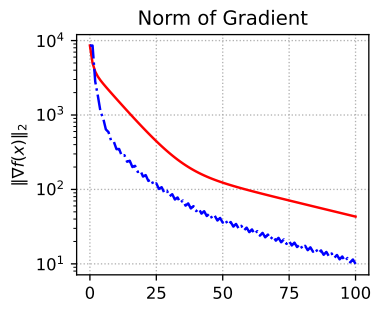
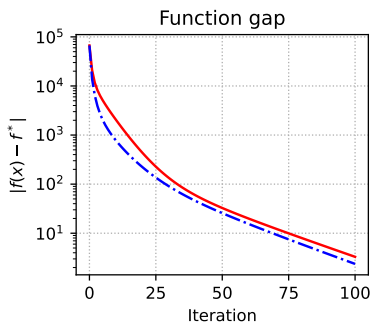
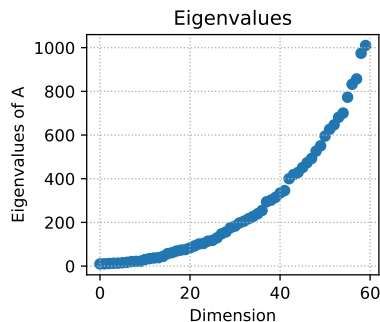


— Gradient Descent - - - Steepest Descent

Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T A x - b^T x \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

Strongly convex quadratics. $n=60$, random matrix.

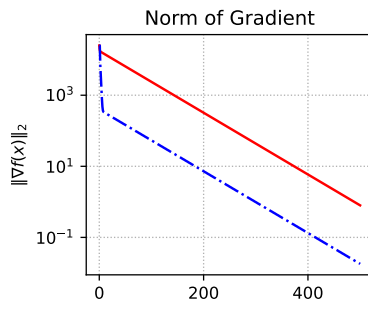
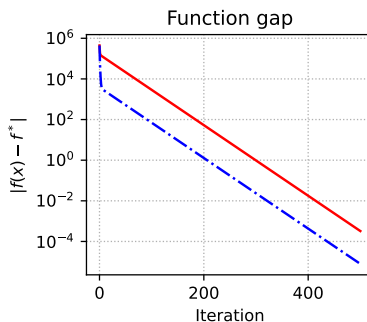
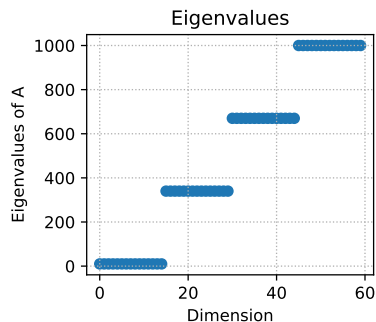


— Gradient Descent - - - Steepest Descent

Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T A x - b^T x \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

Strongly convex quadratics. $n=60$, clustered matrix.

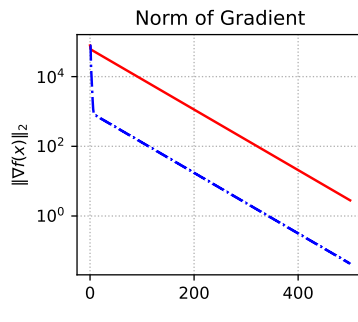
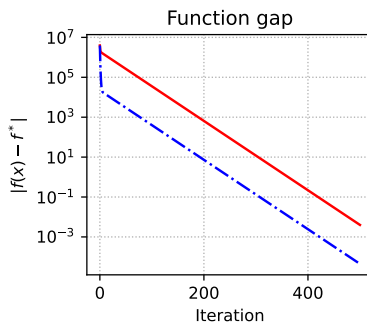
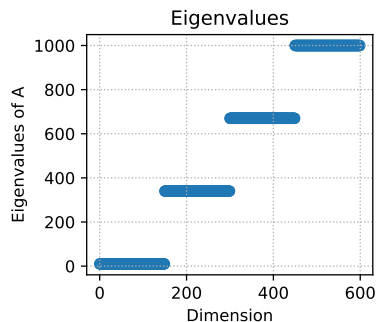


— Gradient Descent -.- Steepest Descent

Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T A x - b^T x \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

Strongly convex quadratics. $n=600$, clustered matrix.

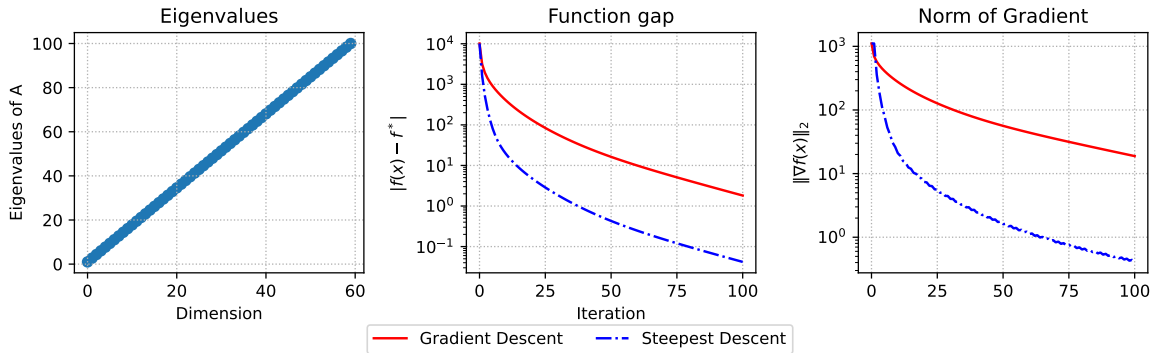


— Gradient Descent -.- Steepest Descent

Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T A x - b^T x \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

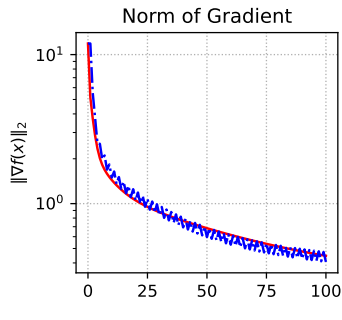
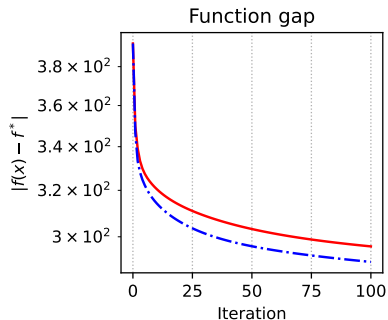
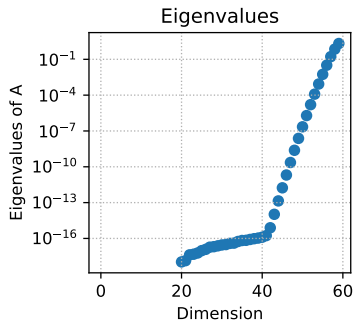
Strongly convex quadratics. $n=60$, uniform spectrum matrix.



Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{2}x^T A x - b^T x \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

Strongly convex quadratics. $n=60$, Hilbert matrix.

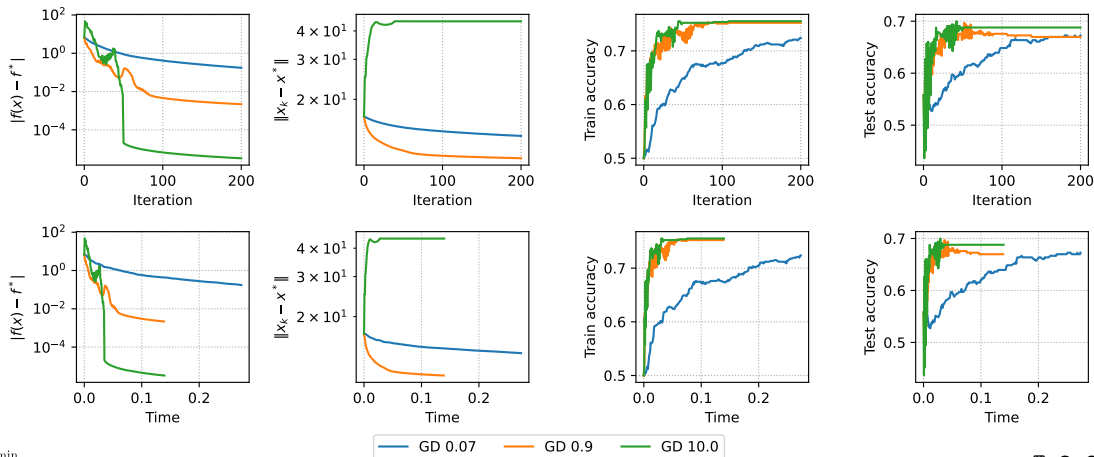


— Gradient Descent - - Steepest Descent

Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{\mu}{2} \|x\|_2^2 + \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m \log(1 + \exp(-y_i \langle a_i, x \rangle)) \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

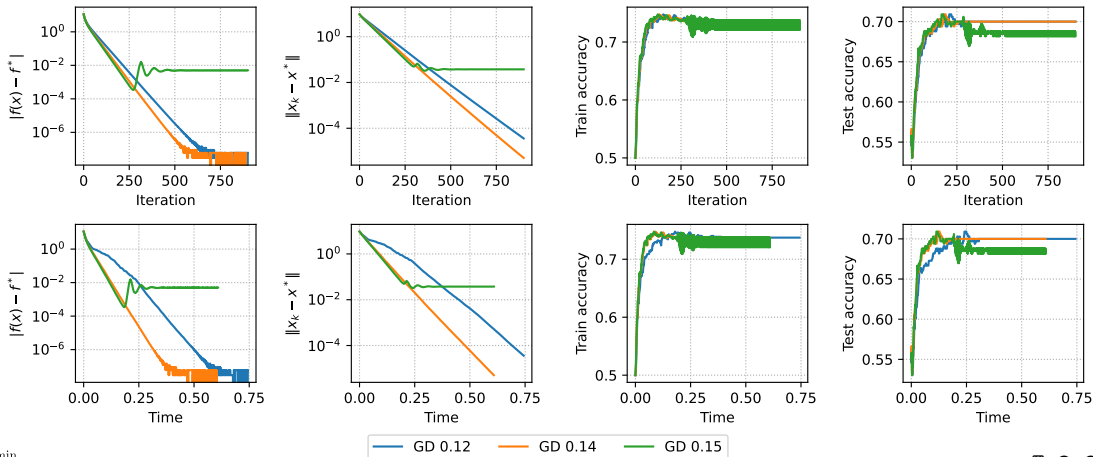
Convex binary logistic regression. $\mu=0$.



Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{\mu}{2} \|x\|_2^2 + \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m \log(1 + \exp(-y_i \langle a_i, x \rangle)) \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

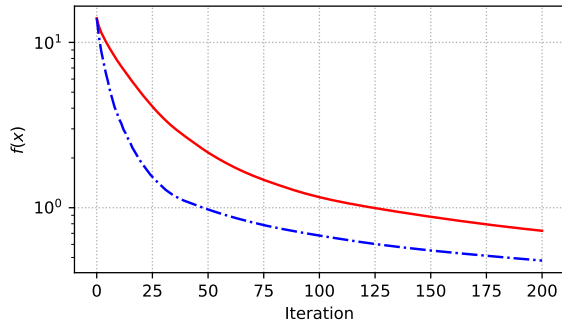
Strongly convex binary logistic regression. $\mu=0.1$.



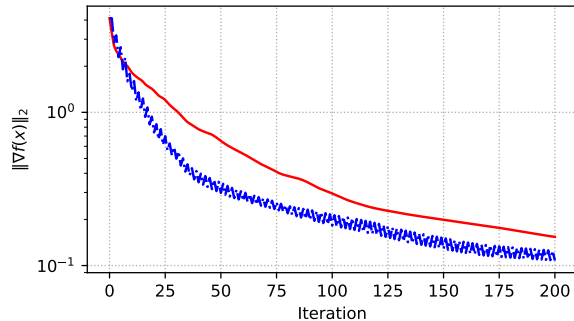
Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{\mu}{2} \|x\|_2^2 + \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m \log(1 + \exp(-y_i \langle a_i, x \rangle)) \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

Regularized binary logistic regression. $n=300$. $m=1000$. $\mu=0$



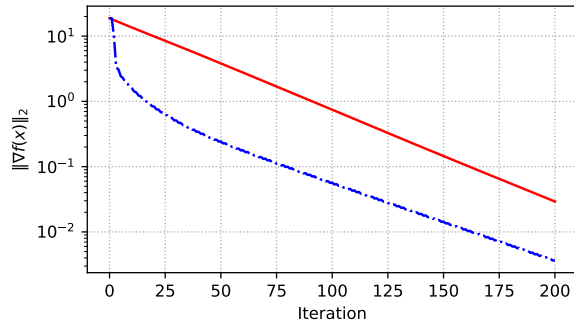
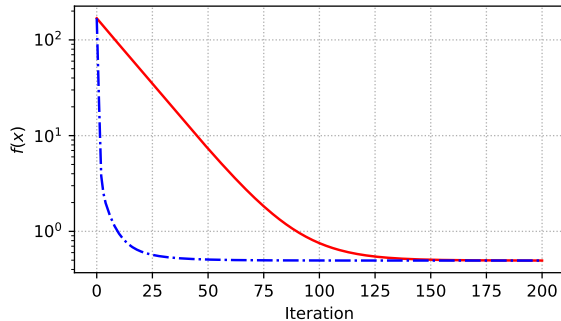
— Gradient Descent -·- Steepest Descent



Numerical experiments

$$f(x) = \frac{\mu}{2} \|x\|_2^2 + \frac{1}{m} \sum_{i=1}^m \log(1 + \exp(-y_i \langle a_i, x \rangle)) \rightarrow \min_{x \in \mathbb{R}^n}$$

Regularized binary logistic regression. $n=300$. $m=1000$. $\mu=1$



— Gradient Descent -.- Steepest Descent